

CLEVELAND BROWNS INTEL REPORT

2026 training camp edition — Myles Garrett is a Ram, Todd Monken is the new head coach, and the quarterback job is genuinely undecided.

UPDATED
July 25, 2026

Todd Monken	Andrew Berry	Rebuild	Jared Verse	Too Close
NEW HEAD COACH	GENERAL MANAGER	STATED POSTURE	GARRETT RETURN	QB BATTLE VERDICT

FRONT OFFICE & LEADERSHIP

- ◆ **Todd Monken takes over.** The former Ravens offensive coordinator (three seasons) returns to Cleveland, where he served one year as OC in 2019. His predecessor, **Kevin Stefanski**, is now the head coach in Atlanta.
- ◆ **Berry accepted reality.** Trading Myles Garrett was the front office formally acknowledging **the franchise is rebuilding** — not retooling.
- ◆ **No hard feelings.** Monken has publicly said he holds no grudge over the offseason drama that preceded Garrett's exit.
- ◆ **The assignment:** settle the quarterback position, and convert the Garrett return into a young defensive core.

TRADES & MAJOR TRANSACTIONS

- ◆ **TRADE** **Myles Garrett to the Rams** — the biggest deal of the 2026 offseason. Cleveland got back EDGE **Jared Verse**, a 25-year-old two-time Pro Bowler, plus multiple picks including a **2027 first-rounder**. Verse's inclusion is what moved the needle.
- ◆ **Verse is the centerpiece.** Getting a young, proven edge rusher rather than pure draft capital is the difference between a teardown and a reset.
- ◆ **Draft additions** including OL **Spencer Fano** and LB **Carson Schwesinger** have been highlighted as reasons for optimism in an otherwise grim year.
- ◆ **CONTEXT** Garrett trade rumors had swirled for months, tying Cleveland to Philadelphia as well before the Rams closed it in June.

PLAYER UPDATES & CAMP BATTLES

- ◆ **QB1** **Deshaun Watson vs. Shedeur Sanders** is the camp. Monken called it **too close to call** at the end of spring workouts — which is either honest or ominous depending on your view.
- ◆ **Deshaun Watson, QB.** Healthy after **two Achilles surgeries** that cost him all of 2025. He has played just **19 games since 2022** between suspension and injury.
- ◆ **Shedeur Sanders, QB.** The other half of a battle that will determine whether Cleveland believes it has a franchise quarterback at all — the actual point of the exercise.
- ◆ **Jared Verse, EDGE.** Two Pro Bowls at 25, now the best player on the roster and the face of what Cleveland got for Garrett.
- ◆ **Spencer Fano, OL & Carson Schwesinger, LB.** Young pieces expected to play immediately in a rebuilding year.
- ◆ **Defensive line, post-Garrett.** Replacing a reigning Defensive Player of the Year is not a job one player does; the whole rotation gets rebuilt around Verse.

LATEST ROSTER MOVES

MOVE	DETAIL
▲ Todd Monken	Hired as head coach from Baltimore
▲ Jared Verse, EDGE	Headlines the Myles Garrett return
▲ 2027 first-round pick	Part of the Garrett package from the Rams
▲ Spencer Fano, OL	Draft addition
▲ Carson Schwesinger, LB	Draft addition
▼ Myles Garrett, EDGE	Traded to the Los Angeles Rams
▼ Kevin Stefanski	Left; now head coach of the Atlanta Falcons

THE BOTTOM LINE

Cleveland stopped pretending. Trading the reigning Defensive Player of the Year for a 25-year-old Pro Bowler and a 2027 first is the cleanest possible admission that this roster needs years, not moves. **Todd Monken's first camp is really a referendum on two quarterbacks** — a healthy Deshaun Watson who has played 19 games in four years, and Shedeur Sanders. If neither answers it, the Browns will have spent the Garrett capital to find out, which was the point.